Mehfil-e-Zan

Gather. Grow. Glow.

BUSINESS CONTINUITY AND INCIDENT RESPONSE PLAN

Keeping guests safe and essential services running when things go wrong

Document ID	MEZ-PLN-003 (assumed)
Document title	Business Continuity and Incident Response Plan
Version	1.0
Effective date	01 November 2026 (assumed)
Last review date	Not yet reviewed (first issue)
Next review date	01 November 2027
Document owner	Operations Officer
Approval authority	CEO and Owner
Status	Draft for approval
Applies to	All employees, trainees, interns, instructors and contractors, and external IT and maintenance support

Student project note: *This document is a student project deliverable. Recovery times, minimum staffing levels, backup schedules and emergency numbers are business assumptions. Emergency numbers, fire, health, labour and data protection rules must be checked for Karachi, Sindh and Pakistan, and reviewed by a qualified adviser, before a real business adopts this plan.*

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

Power cuts, internet failures, lost files, a security scare or a sick team can happen to any business. This plan helps Mehfil-e-Zan protect people first, keep essential services running, restore normal operations quickly and learn from each event. It is basic and practical, so that every shift knows what to do.

1.2 Scope

It covers IT outages, data loss, security incidents, operational disruptions, unexpected staff absences and client service interruptions. It also sets emergency communications, backup and recovery procedures and recovery priorities.

1.3 Business assumptions

- Mehfil-e-Zan is a women-only cafe and community space in Gulshan-e-Iqbal, Karachi, open daily from 10:00 AM to 10:00 PM, with 40 seats.
- Key systems: WiFi and internet, POS or till, booking and CRM tools, WhatsApp Business, social media accounts, cloud drive and email, and accounting files.
- Karachi risks include power cuts, heavy rain and flooding, heatwaves, water shortage, road closures and strikes, and mobile or internet slowdowns.
- The cafe has a backup power source (generator or UPS) for lights, fridges and the POS, and a mobile hotspot as internet backup.

1.4 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Link to this plan
MEZ-SOP-002	Security Measures SOP	Security, entry, privacy, evacuation
MEZ-POL-001	IT Rules and Regulations Policy	Systems, accounts, backups
MEZ-SOP-010	Operations and Quality Control SOP	Incident levels, CAPA
MEZ-SOP-009	Finance and Expense Management SOP	Emergency spending, cash
MEZ-POL-002	HR and Employee Management Policy	Attendance, leave
MEZ-ORG-001	Organizational Chart and Job Descriptions	Cover and delegation
MEZ-TPL-001	Forms, Registers and Templates	IT issue and security incident reports
MEZ-FRM-054 to 056	Plan forms (Annexes A to C)	Contacts, restore test, post-incident review

Note: *Document and form numbers are assumed and should be matched to the master Document Register (MEZ-REG-001).*

2. Roles and Responsibilities

2.1 Incident Response Team

Role in an incident	Who	Deputy	Main duties
Incident Commander	CEO	Operations Officer	Declares Level 3, makes final decisions, approves emergency spending and public statements with the Owner
Operations Lead	Operations Officer	Supervisor	Keeps essential services running, organises staff cover, suppliers and repairs
IT Lead	IT Manager	External IT support	Restores systems and data, contains cyber incidents, keeps the IT log
Safety and Security Lead	Security & Safety Manager	Supervisor on shift	Protects people, leads evacuation, first aid, police and emergency services, controls entry
Communications Lead	HR / Sales / Marketing Manager	Marketing Executive	Informs staff, guests, members and the public. Monitors social media. Prepares statements
Finance Lead	Finance Director	CEO	Emergency payments, cash security, insurance, cost tracking
Records Lead	Documentation & Compliance Coordinator	Sales Executive	Logs the incident and decisions, collects evidence, files reports and the post-incident review
First responder on shift	Supervisor	Senior cafe staff member	Takes first action, informs the Incident Commander, protects guests and staff

2.2 All employees

- Know where the exits, first aid kit, fire extinguishers, main power switch and water valve are.
- Report any incident or near miss at once to the Supervisor. Do not delay, hide or try to fix it alone.
- Follow instructions from the Incident Commander and the Safety and Security Lead during an emergency.
- Keep the emergency contact list (Annex A) on the staff notice board and in the staff WhatsApp group.

3. Guiding Principles

Principle	What it means in practice
People first	Life and safety come before property, money and data.
Guest privacy and dignity	Our women-only promise is kept even in an emergency. Photos and information are protected.

Principle	What it means in practice
Act early, report early	A small problem handled quickly is cheaper than a big one found late.
One decision-maker	The Incident Commander decides. Everyone else supports.
Honest communication	We tell guests and staff the truth, kindly and clearly. We do not guess or blame.
Learn and improve	Every incident ends with a review and fixes (CAPA, MEZ-SOP-010).

4. Critical Activities and Recovery Priorities

4.1 Recovery priorities

RTO is the longest time we accept a function being down. **RPO** is the most data we accept losing. Times are assumptions.

Priority	Critical activity	Depends on	RTO	RPO
1	Safety, first aid, evacuation, entry control	Staff, exits, alarms, phone	Immediate	Not applicable
2	Guest payment and billing (cash, QR, bank transfer)	Till, POS, mobile phone, hotspot	1 hour (manual backup at once)	Same day
3	Food and beverage service	Power, water, gas, stock, equipment, staff	2 hours (reduced menu)	Not applicable
4	Communication with guests and staff	WhatsApp, phone, social media	1 hour	1 day
5	Bookings, memberships and events (CRM, calendar)	Cloud tools, internet, staff	4 hours (use paper list)	1 day
6	Reading and work corner (WiFi, sockets)	Internet, power	8 hours	Not applicable
7	Payroll, vendor payments and records	Accounting files, bank access	2 working days	1 day
8	Marketing, social media posting, reporting	Accounts, devices	3 working days	1 day

4.2 Main risks

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Main controls
Power cut	High	Medium	UPS or generator, fuel plan, battery lights, fridge discipline
Internet or WiFi outage	High	Medium	Mobile hotspot, second provider if budget allows, offline order slips
Lost or damaged device, accidental deletion	Medium	Medium	Daily cloud backup, version history, device passwords

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Main controls
Phishing, hacked account, ransomware	Medium	High	Two-step verification, training, offline backup, access controls
Unauthorised entry, harassment, theft, privacy breach	Low to medium	High	Entry control, visitor register, trained staff, MEZ-SOP-002
Fire, flood or heavy rain, heatwave	Medium	High	Extinguishers, drills, drainage, shaded cooling plan, insurance
Food safety incident	Low	High	Hygiene checks, temperature logs, supplier checks (MEZ-SOP-010)
Staff illness or sudden absence	High	Medium	Cross-training, standby list, reduced operations plan
Strike, protest or road closure	Medium	Medium	Early warning, remote work for office roles, early closing plan
Supplier failure	Medium	Medium	Second supplier for key items, safety stock

5. Incident Levels and Declaration

Level	Description	Examples	Who declares	Who leads
1. Minor	Small, local, easy to fix. No danger.	WiFi slowdown, one till down, one staff member late	Supervisor	Supervisor
2. Moderate	Service affected for part of the day. Some risk.	Internet down over 1 hour, equipment failure, 2 staff absent, suspected phishing	Operations Officer or the relevant lead	Operations Officer or lead
3. Major	Safety, privacy or reputation at risk, or the business cannot operate.	Fire, injury, data breach, ransomware, long power cut, assault, food poisoning, closure	CEO, or Security & Safety Manager for safety events	CEO as Incident Commander

If in doubt, treat the incident as one level higher. Levels match MEZ-SOP-010, so reports and CAPA use the same language.

6. General Incident Response Procedure

Phase	What to do	Who
1. Detect and report	Anyone who sees a problem tells the Supervisor immediately. The Supervisor calls the relevant lead.	All staff
2. Assess	What happened, who is at risk, what is affected, how long it may last. Decide the level.	Supervisor, lead
3. Make safe	Protect people first. Evacuate or move guests if needed. Call emergency services. Secure cash, data and premises.	Safety and Security Lead
4. Contain	Stop the problem from spreading. Isolate systems, close the affected area, stop the affected activity.	Relevant lead

Phase	What to do	Who
5. Communicate	Inform the Incident Commander, staff and guests as per Section 13.	Communications Lead
6. Continue essential services	Switch to workarounds in Sections 7 to 10 and follow recovery priorities in Section 4.	Operations Lead
7. Recover	Fix, restore, test and return to normal. Confirm with the Incident Commander.	Relevant lead
8. Record and review	Complete the incident report, log decisions and costs, hold the post-incident review (Annex C) within 7 days, and raise CAPA.	Records Lead, Operations Officer

Golden rules: protect people first, do not tamper with evidence, do not delete anything in a cyber incident, and speak to the media only through the CEO or Owner.

7. IT Outages

Outage	Immediate action	Workaround	Recover
Internet or WiFi down	Restart router once. Call the provider. Tell the IT Manager.	Switch to mobile hotspot for POS and bookings. Tell guests the work corner WiFi is limited.	Provider fixes. IT Manager tests speed and reports.
POS or till system down	Switch to manual order slips and numbered receipts.	Cash, QR or bank transfers recorded in the manual sheet. Two people check the count.	Enter manual sales into the system within 24 hours. Finance checks totals.
Power cut	Switch to UPS or generator. Protect fridges. Check lighting and exits.	Cook with gas, serve cold items and use battery lights. Reduced menu.	Check equipment after power returns. Log fridge temperatures.
Booking or CRM tool down	Use the paper booking list and WhatsApp messages.	Confirm bookings by phone. Keep screenshots.	Update the CRM when it is back and compare.
Email or cloud drive down	Use WhatsApp and phone. Use offline copies if available.	Share urgent files via a secure alternative.	IT Manager checks for lost messages.
Social media account locked	Report to the platform. Change passwords. Tell the Communications Lead.	Post notices on WhatsApp status or the website.	Account recovery, security check, review of access.

The IT Manager keeps an IT Issue Report for each outage (MEZ-TPL-001). Outages longer than 1 hour become Level 2. Outages longer than 4 hours, or any outage that affects safety or privacy, become Level 3.

8. Data Loss, Backup and Recovery

8.1 Backup rules (3-2-1)

- Keep **3** copies of important data, on **2** different types of storage, with **1** copy off the premises (cloud or a secured drive kept elsewhere).

- Backups are automatic where possible. The IT Manager checks they ran every working day.
- Backups are encrypted and protected by passwords and two-step verification. Access is limited to named people.

Data	Where it lives	Backup	Kept for	Owner
Sales, POS and booking data	POS and CRM	Daily export to cloud drive	6 years	IT Manager, Finance Director
Accounting and payroll files	Finance computer and drive	Daily to cloud, weekly to external drive	6 years	Finance Director
Personnel files	Restricted drive and locked cabinet	Weekly to cloud	As per MEZ-POL-002	HR / Sales / Marketing Manager
Policies, SOPs and forms	Document drive	Daily to cloud, version history on	Current and previous versions	Documentation & Compliance Coordinator
Guest consents and photos	Marketing folder	Weekly to cloud	As per MEZ-GDL-001	Marketing Executive
Website and social content	Website host, accounts	Monthly export	2 years	Marketing Executive, IT Manager

8.2 Restore testing

- Test a restore of one file and one system every month, and a full restore test every 6 months. Record results in Annex B.
- A backup that has not been tested is not trusted.

8.3 If data is lost or corrupted

1. Stop using the affected device or file. Do not overwrite or delete anything.
2. Tell the IT Manager at once and record the time, device and what was lost.
3. The IT Manager finds the latest good backup and restores to a safe copy. Data between the last backup and the loss is re-entered from paper, receipts or messages.
4. Check the restored data with the owner of the data (for example Finance for accounts).
5. If personal data may have been exposed, treat it as a security incident (Section 9).
6. Record the incident and fix the cause, for example a missing backup, a weak password or user error.

9. Security Incidents

9.1 Cyber incidents

Incident	First steps	Lead
Phishing or suspicious message	Do not click or reply. Report to the IT Manager. Delete after reporting.	IT Manager

Incident	First steps	Lead
Hacked or compromised account	Change the password, log out all sessions, turn on two-step verification, check activity, tell the Communications Lead if social media.	IT Manager
Ransomware or malware	Disconnect the device from WiFi and power off. Do not pay or negotiate. Tell the CEO. Restore from a clean backup.	IT Manager, CEO
Lost or stolen phone or laptop	Remote lock or wipe, change passwords, report to the IT Manager and the police if stolen.	IT Manager
Data leak (guest, member or staff data)	Contain, find what was exposed, inform the CEO. Tell the affected people honestly, and report to authorities if the law requires.	CEO, IT Manager

9.2 Physical security incidents

Incident	First steps	Lead
Unauthorised or suspicious person	Staff stay calm, politely ask the person to leave or wait at the front desk. Call the Supervisor. Do not argue or use force.	Security & Safety Manager
Harassment, threat or violence	Move guests and staff to safety. Call the police (15) if there is danger. Support the person affected privately. Preserve any evidence.	Security & Safety Manager, CEO
Theft or damage	Do not touch the scene. Record details, check footage if available, and report to the police if needed.	Security & Safety Manager
Privacy breach, such as photographing guests without consent	Stop the person politely, ask them to delete the photos in front of the staff, record the incident, and apologise to the guest.	Security & Safety Manager
Bomb threat or unrest nearby	Follow the evacuation procedure. Call the police. Do not use mobile phones near a suspected device.	Incident Commander

- Every security incident is recorded on the Security Incident Report (MEZ-TPL-001).
- Guest and staff details are shared with the police only as needed. The CEO approves any wider sharing.
- Support is offered to anyone affected. HR checks in with staff within 2 days.

10. Operational Disruptions

Disruption	Immediate action	Continuity option	Decision by
Fire or smoke	Raise the alarm, evacuate, call the fire brigade (16). Do not use lifts. Assemble at the meeting point and count people.	Close until the premises are declared safe	Security & Safety Manager
Flooding or heavy rain	Move guests from wet areas, switch off sockets in affected zones, protect stock and electrical items.	Close early or open with limited areas. Offer a later event date.	Operations Officer, CEO

Disruption	Immediate action	Continuity option	Decision by
Heatwave or cooling failure	Check guests and staff. Offer water and rest. Fix air conditioning.	Shorter hours, cold menu, limit capacity	Operations Officer
Water shortage	Order a water tanker. Use bottled water for drinks. Stop food preparation if hygiene cannot be met.	Cold drinks and packaged items only. Close the kitchen if needed.	Operations Officer
Gas leak or smell	Do not switch anything on. Open windows, close the gas valve, evacuate, call the supplier and the fire brigade.	Close until cleared	Security & Safety Manager
Food safety incident	Stop serving the suspect item. Keep samples. Help affected guests and call a doctor or ambulance (115) if needed.	Limited menu from safe stock	CEO, Operations Officer
Strike, protest or road closure	Check news and staff safety early in the day. Tell staff and guests of changes.	Late opening, early closing, pre-orders, remote work for office roles	CEO
Supplier failure	Use the second supplier or local market. Change the menu.	Reduced menu	Operations Officer
Premises unavailable	Move to a temporary site if possible, or pause services. Protect records and equipment.	Online sessions and take-away from a partner site	CEO and Owner

- A closure decision is made by the CEO, or by the Security & Safety Manager if safety is at risk. The Supervisor can close immediately in an emergency and inform the CEO.
- When we close, we make sure all guests and staff have left safely, secure cash and records, and switch off power and gas.

11. Unexpected Employee Absences

11.1 Minimum staffing to open (assumed)

Level	Minimum on shift	Operating mode
Normal	Supervisor, 2 to 3 cafe staff, 1 to 2 kitchen helpers, 1 cleaner, front desk	Full menu, full events
Reduced	Supervisor, 2 cafe staff, 1 kitchen helper, 1 cleaner (front desk done by the Sales Executive or Supervisor)	Shorter menu, events continue with simple set-up
Minimum safe	Supervisor or Operations Officer, 1 cafe staff, 1 kitchen helper. Cleaning shared	Cold drinks, chai, packaged snacks, limited seating, no events
Cannot open safely	Less than the minimum safe level, or no person trained in first aid and safety	Close or open late. Inform guests

11.2 Steps when staff are absent

1. The employee informs the Supervisor as early as possible (MEZ-POL-002). The Supervisor logs it in the attendance register.
2. The Supervisor calls the standby list (part-time staff, trained trainees, staff on their day off) and tells the Operations Officer.
3. Move people between stations. Use the cross-training matrix to select who can cover what.
4. Switch to a reduced or minimum operating mode if needed. Tell guests honestly.
5. The Operations Officer tells HR if absence continues, and HR arranges temporary staff or reassignment.
6. Record the impact in the daily report. Repeated absence patterns are reviewed by HR.

11.3 Absence of a key person

The deputy in MEZ-ORG-001, Section 10, takes over with the limits stated there. For an absence of more than 1 day, a Delegation of Authority Form is completed. Passwords and key files are kept by a second authorised person, so no function depends on only one person.

11.4 Mass absence, illness or an emergency affecting many staff

- If more than 30% of staff are absent for 2 or more days, the CEO declares a Level 2 incident and decides on reduced hours or temporary closure.
- If many staff are ill, the Safety and Security Lead checks for a common cause, such as a food or health issue, and follows health advice.
- Staff well-being is considered: no one is forced to work when ill, and leave is handled fairly.

12. Client Service Interruptions

12.1 Principles

- Tell people early, honestly and in simple words, with a new time or a fair solution.
- Keep to the promises we have made in writing (MEZ-SOP-008). Refunds and credits follow the approval limits in MEZ-ORG-001.
- Look after the most affected first: guests already in the cafe, then event participants, private booking clients, members, and then general followers.

12.2 Actions by situation

Situation	Action for guests and clients	Owner
Guests in the cafe when an incident starts	Explain calmly, move them to safety, offer water, keep their bill fair and waive it if service cannot be completed.	Supervisor
Workshop or event cannot go ahead	Message participants and the instructor at once. Offer a new date, a credit or a refund. Thank instructors and pay agreed fees where fair.	Sales Executive, Operations Officer
Private booking affected	Call the client the same day. Offer an alternative date or space, or a full refund of the deposit. Do not blame.	Sales Executive, CEO

Situation	Action for guests and clients	Owner
Membership service disrupted (closure over 2 days)	Extend the membership by the number of days closed, or credit, and tell members in writing.	HR / Sales / Marketing Manager
Online channels down	Post notices on the available channels, use WhatsApp broadcast, call priority clients.	Marketing Executive
A guest is harmed or upset by the incident	Give first aid, listen, apologise, record, and follow the complaint process. The CEO may call personally.	Supervisor, CEO

All client interruptions are recorded, and affected clients are contacted after the event to check their satisfaction and offer help.

13. Emergency Communications

13.1 Who speaks and to whom

Audience	Who communicates	Channel	When
Staff on shift	Supervisor, Safety and Security Lead	In person, then staff WhatsApp group	Immediately
All staff	Communications Lead	Staff WhatsApp group and phone calls	Within 30 minutes of a Level 2 or 3 declaration
Owner	CEO	Phone call	Within 30 minutes of Level 3
Guests in the premises	Supervisor or CEO	In person, calm and clear	Immediately
Booked guests, members and event participants	Sales Executive, Communications Lead	WhatsApp, phone, email	Within 2 hours of a decision
Public and social media	Communications Lead with CEO approval	Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp status, website	Within 2 hours for a Level 3
Police, fire, ambulance	Safety and Security Lead or any employee	Phone	Immediately, if life or property is at risk
Suppliers, landlord, insurer, IT provider	Operations Lead, Finance Lead, IT Lead	Phone, email	As soon as possible
Media	CEO or Owner only	Written statement	After approval

13.2 Message rules

- Say what happened, what we are doing, what guests should do and when we will update them. Keep it short and kind.
- Do not name people involved, share private details, guess the cause or blame others.
- One approved message is used for all channels. Staff do not post on personal accounts about the incident.

- Update at the times promised, and send a final “we are back to normal” message.

13.3 Sample messages

Situation	Message (edit before use)
Temporary closure	Dear guests, Mehfil-e-Zan is closed today because of [reason]. Your safety comes first. Booked guests will be contacted directly. We will update you by [time]. Thank you for your understanding.
Event postponed	Dear [name], we are sorry that [event] on [date] must be moved to [new date] because of [reason]. If this does not suit you, we can offer a credit or refund. Please reply and we will help.
Service disruption	Please note that WiFi and card payments are limited today. You can pay by cash or bank transfer. Thank you for your patience.
Staff update	Team, there is a [level] incident: [short facts]. Please follow your Supervisor’s instructions. Do not share details outside the team. Next update at [time].

14. Recovery and Return to Normal

1. The relevant lead confirms that the cause is fixed and the area, system or service is safe.
2. The Safety and Security Lead clears the premises for guests (for fire, flood, gas or security incidents).
3. The IT Lead tests systems, accounts and data. The Finance Lead checks cash and records.
4. The Operations Lead restores the full menu, events and shifts in the order of the recovery priorities.
5. The Incident Commander declares the incident closed. The Communications Lead informs staff, guests and the public.
6. The Records Lead files the incident log, costs, insurance claim and evidence.
7. The post-incident review (Annex C) is held within 7 days. Actions go into the CAPA Register.

15. Testing, Training and Maintenance of this Plan

Activity	Frequency	Responsible
Fire and evacuation drill	Twice a year	Security & Safety Manager
Backup restore test	Monthly (file), every 6 months (full)	IT Manager
Cyber awareness and phishing training	Yearly, with reminders	IT Manager
Tabletop exercise (talk through a scenario such as a power cut and an absence)	Twice a year	Operations Officer
Emergency contact list checked and updated	Quarterly	Documentation & Compliance Coordinator
Fire extinguishers, first aid kit and emergency lights checked	Monthly	Security & Safety Manager

Activity	Frequency	Responsible
Cross-training matrix updated	Twice a year	Operations Officer and HR / Sales / Marketing Manager
Review of this plan after every Level 3 incident, and full review	Yearly	CEO and Owner

16. Compliance, Review and Approval

16.1 Training and acknowledgement

- Every employee is briefed on this plan in her first week and signs an acknowledgement. Staff attend a refresher every year and take part in drills.

16.2 Compliance checks

Check	Frequency	Responsible
Emergency contacts and equipment checked	Quarterly	Security & Safety Manager
Backups run and restore tests recorded	Monthly	IT Manager
Incident reports complete and closed	Monthly	Documentation & Compliance Coordinator
CAPA from incidents closed on time	Monthly	Operations Officer
Drills held and attendance recorded	Twice a year	Security & Safety Manager
Full review of this plan	Yearly	CEO and Owner

16.3 Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Prepared by: Operations Officer			
Reviewed by: Security & Safety Manager			
Approved by: CEO			
Approved by: Owner			

Annex A. Emergency Contact List (MEZ-FRM-054)

Keep on the notice board and in the staff WhatsApp group. Suggested entries: Police (15), Fire brigade (16), Edhi ambulance (115), nearest hospital, Owner, CEO, each manager, Supervisor, landlord, electricity company (K-Electric), water and gas suppliers, internet provider, IT support, insurer, key suppliers, bank. Please verify all numbers before use.

Contact	Name	Phone	Notes

Annex B. Backup and Restore Test Record (MEZ-FRM-055)

Date	System or data tested	Backup used	Result (pass / fail)	Time to restore	Tester

Annex C. Post-Incident Review Form (MEZ-FRM-056)

Field	Details
Incident number, date and time	
Level and type of incident	
What happened (timeline)	
People and services affected	
What worked well	
What did not work	
Root cause (5 whys)	
Impact on guests, staff and finances (PKR)	
Corrective and preventive actions, owners and due dates (CAPA numbers)	
Changes needed to this plan	
Review held on (date) and attendees	
Approved by the Incident Commander and date	